

Debbie Van Kiekebelt

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Deborah "Debbie" Van Kiekebelt (born March 1, 1954, in [Kitchener, Ontario](#))^[1] is a [Canadian](#) athlete and sports broadcaster. She was a gold medallist in the [pentathlon](#) at the [1971 Pan American Games](#), and was named that year's Canadian Woman Athlete of the year. Later, she became Canada's first female sports broadcaster.^[2]

Van Kiekebelt attended [Clarkson Secondary School](#) in [Mississauga, Ontario](#). During her high school days at Clarkson, she not only captured many [Peel regional](#) titles, but set records in several events.^[1]

Van Kiekebelt finished second behind fellow Canadian [Debbie Brill](#) in the high jump event at the British [1971 WAAA Championships](#).^{[3][4]}

After her Pan-Am gold medal win in [Cali](#), Colombia, in the pentathlon, She competed in the Long Jump and Pentathlon at the 1972 Olympic games in Munich. Where she failed to advance to final in the long jump, and place 15th in the Pentathlon. She won a silver medal in the high jump at the 1973 Pacific Conference Games; she was appointed to the Mississauga Sports Hall of Fame in 1977. She became the first female Canadian sports broadcaster, appearing on [Citytv](#) and [NBC](#), and was host of six television series.^[5]

Van Kiekebelt was a director for the See You In Athens Fund which supported Canadian athletes attending the [2004 Summer Olympics](#).^[5]

References [[edit](#)]

- Evans, Hilary; Gjerde, Arild; Heijmans, Jeroen; [Mallon, Bill](#); et al. "[Debbie Van Kiekebelt](#)" . *Olympics at Sports-Reference.com*. [Sports Reference LLC](#). Archived from [the original](#) on 2020-04-18.

1.

^a

^b

"[Debbie Van Kiekebelt](#)" . Mississauga Sports Council. Archived from [the original](#) on 2010-06-27. Retrieved 2008-07-09.

2.

[^]

Berkoff, Fran (1 April 2002). "[Called to the bar](#)" . [Calgary Sun](#). Archived from [the original](#) on 19 October 2006. Retrieved 2008-07-09.

3.

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"[Women's AAA Results](#)" . *Sunday Sun (Newcastle)*. 18 July 1971. Retrieved 7 March 2025 – via British Newspaper Archive.
- ### Debbie Van Kiekebelt
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|-------------------------------------|--|----------------------------|
| | Personal information | |
| Born | March 1, 1954 (age 72) <div>Kitchener, Ontario</div> | |
| | Medal record | [hide] |
| | Women's athletics | |
| | Representing Canada | |
| | Pan American Games | |
| G | 1971 Cali | Pentathlon |
| | Pacific Conference Games | |
| S | 1973 Toronto | High jump |

- | | | |
|------------------------------|--|--------|
| V • T • E | Pan American Champions in women's pentathlon and heptathlon | [hide] |
| Pentathlon | 1967: Pat Winslow (USA) <div>1971: Debbie Van Kiekebelt (CAN)</div> <div>1983: Conceição Geremias (BRA)</div> <div>1987: Cindy Greiner (USA)</div> | |
| Heptathlon | 1991: DeDee Nathan (USA) <div>1995: Jamie McNeair (USA)</div> <div>1999: Magalys García (CUB)</div> <div>2003: Tiffany Lott-Hogan (USA)</div> <div>1975: Diane Jones-Konihowski (CAN)</div> <div>1979: Diane Jones-Konihowski (CAN)</div> <div>2007: Jessica Zelinka (CAN)</div> <div>2011: Lucimara Silvestre (BRA)</div> <div>2015: Yorgelis Rodríguez (CUB)</div> <div>2019: Adriana Rodríguez (CUB)</div> <div>2023: Erin Marsh (USA)</div> | |
| V • T • E | Bobbie Rosenfeld Award | [hide] |
| 1932–1950 | Hilda Strike (1932) • Ada Mackenzie (1933) • Phyllis Dewar (1934) • Aileen Meagher (1935) • Betty Taylor (1936) • Robina Higgins (1937) • Noel MacDonald (1938) • Mary Rose Thacker (1939) • Dorothy Walton (1940) • Mary Rose Thacker (1941) • Barbara Ann Scott (1946) • Barbara Ann Scott (1947) • Barbara Ann Scott (1948) • Irene Strong (1949) • Bobbie Rosenfeld (1950) | |
| 1952–1975 | Marlene Streit (1952) • Marlene Streit (1953) • Marilyn Bell (1954) • Marilyn Bell (1955) • Marlene Streit (1956) • Marlene Streit (1957) • Lucile Wheeler (1958) • Anne Heggteveit (1959) • Anne Heggteveit (1960) • Mary Stewart (1961) • Mary Stewart (1962) • Marlene Streit (1963) • Petra Burka (1964) • Petra Burka (1965) • Elaine Tanner (1966) • Nancy Greene (1967) • Nancy Greene (1968) • Beverly Boys (1969) • Beverly Boys (1970) • Debbie Van Kiekebelt / Debbie Brill (1971) • Jocelyne Bourassa (1972) • Karen Magnussen (1973) • Wendy Cook (1974) • Nancy Garapick (1975) | |
| 1976–2000 | Kathy Kreiner (1976) • Cindy Nicholas (1977) • Diane Jones-Konihowski (1978) • Sandra Post (1979) • Sandra Post (1980) • Tracey Wainman (1981) • Gerry Sorensen (1982) • Carling Bassett (1983) • Sylvie Bernier (1984) • Carling Bassett (1985) • Laurie Graham (1986) • Carolyn Waldo (1987) • Carolyn Waldo (1988) • Helen Kelesi (1989) • Helen Kelesi (1990) • Silken Laumann (1991) • Silken Laumann (1992) • Kate Pace (1993) • Myriam Bédard (1994) • Susan Auch (1995) • Alison Sydor (1996) • Lorie Kane (1997) • Catriona Le May Doan (1998) • Nancy Greene (1999) • Lorie Kane (2000) | |
| 2001–present | Catriona Le May Doan (2001) • Catriona Le May Doan (2002) • Perdita Felicien (2003) • Lori-Ann Muenzer (2004) • Cindy Klassen (2005) • Cindy Klassen (2006) • Hayley Wickenheiser (2007) • Chantal Petitclerc (2008) • Aleksandra Wozniak (2009) • Joannie Rochette (2010) • Jennifer Heil (2011) • Christine Sinclair (2012) • Eugenie Bouchard (2013) • Eugenie Bouchard (2014) • Brooke Henderson (2015) • Penny Oleksiak (2016) • Brooke Henderson (2017) • Brooke Henderson (2018) • Bianca Andreescu (2019) • Christine Sinclair (2020) • Leylah Fernandez (2021) • Marie-Philip Poulin (2022) • Summer McIntosh (2023) • Summer McIntosh (2024) • Summer McIntosh (2025) | |
| | Commons | |
| V • T • E | USA Indoor Track and Field Championships winners in women's high jump | [show] |
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| [Athletes \(track and field\) at the 1970 British Commonwealth Games](#)
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